

Sun Spots

By RAY KEYES

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You can begin watching with interest shortly the news that comes out of Clearwater, Fla., training base of the Philadelphia Phillies, parent club of the Williamsport Grays.

Most of the news, of course, will be about determined veterans. But the topics most interesting to the folks of this nine-county area will be about the eager kids. They are the ones likely to find their way to Bowman Field this year, even if only for that so-called cup of coffee.

When the Phils are at full strength in camp after March 1, their number will be 55. Included will be 15 youngsters who have minor league contracts for 1960. Of these 15, four are assigned to the Grays. They'll be getting that major league training before they switch to the Williamsport camp at Plant City after mid-March.

One of the four Grays at Clearwater will be Bob (Frenchy) Baillargeon, the hard-throwing righthander who won't be 19 until August.



BOB BAILLARGEON

Frenchy joined the Grays late last season, appeared in four games, posted a 1-1 record and looked like a real prospect. Before coming here he was 15-8 in Class D ball at Elmira. For his fifth victory of the season last June 6, he hurled a no-hitter at Geneva.

Another pitcher with a Williamsport pact is Dwight Siebler. In 1958, when the Phils had players coming and going here in such a large quantity that it was hard to keep up with what was going on, Siebler spent some time with the club. Last year in Class C ball at Bakersfield, Cal., he was 11-7. The 22-year-old University of Nebraska rightie was an All-Big Eight choice in college.

The other half of the four are infielders—Lee Elia and Gene Kerns. Elia was impressive in his inaugural year at Elmira last term, hitting .308 and playing bang-up ball at third base. Kerns is of unknown quality in OB, for this will be his first time out. Chances are the Hancock, Md., youngster, singled by Dutch Dorman, will go to a "D" club this term.

Also in the Phil camp from last year's Grays, in addition to veteran southpaw Curt Simmons, are pitchers Al Neiger, Ed Keegan and Art Mahaffey and Outfielder Tony Curry. Neiger, just off the University of Delaware campus, looks like a real comer. The lefty was 7-4 here, and showed the tools that are needed to qualify for the majors.

ALL SORTS OF SPORTS — Williamsport skipper in 1958, Dick Carter, is back as a coach with the Phils. The other coaches are Ken Silvestri and Andy Cohen. . . . The annual Father-Son Basketball Dinner of Ohev Shalom will be held March 16. . . . The Susquehanna University basketball team that comes here tomorrow night to play Lycoming is coached by Johnny Barr of Shamokin, former Penn State and Eastern League stickout. . . . Lycoming (4-11) needs to win one of its three remaining games to exceed its victory total of a year ago. . . . New York is the only city to be the scene of a pre-season major league exhibition this spring. The Yanks play the Red Sox April 16-17.